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Section Title(S)

2) RELATIONS ON THE HUSBAND'S SIDE. • c) The tinamu.

There is still a *third kind of bulamu*. I also call tinamu the cousins of my wife who are the daughters of my wife's mother's sisters. These girls do not belong to my wife's clan; they bear the family name of their father. Therefore I have no right to inherit them: "A hi delani ndjaka," i. e. "we do not inherit from each other." The relations with these tinamu are agreeable, but there is no hope of marriage between us.

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2) RELATIONS ON THE HUSBAND'S SIDE.

So far we have considered the relation of Mboza with his wife's family. But what about Nsabula and her position towards her husband's relatives? Nsabula calls Masuluke and Nsengamuñwe *ñwingi*, and the term is reciprocal. It implies great respect. As we saw, the young bride must work a whole year for her mother-in-law. The same respect is shown by Nsabula to Djan, Sam, Fos, her husband's elder brothers. They are also *ñwingi* to each other. "Should I send her to call Djan," says Mboza, "she will kneel down before him and say: 'My father! Mboza calls you!' or: 'Ñwamasuluke (Masuluke's son), you are wanted with us.'" She will not dare to address him by name. This extraordinary respect is reciprocal. Djan will consider Nsabula as his inferior, but he will never play with her. On the other hand, Komatane, Mboza's younger brother, is only a *namu* to Nsabula. Both will joke together and even occasionally smear each other with ashes. So will Sam, Fos, Mboza and Komatane with Mhlakaza, the wife of their elder brother. Thus we note this law: a woman will generally respect the elder brothers of her husband (bengi), and hold very free intercourse with his younger brothers (tinamu), and vice-versa. A man will

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keep away from 249 his younger brother's wives (bengi) and play with those of his elder brothers (tinamu). Why tis here this difference? Because, as we saw, the wife of an elder brother is a possible wife for all his younger brothers, as they have the right of inheriting her, should this man die. On the contrary, an elder brother inherits his younger brother's wife only under quite exceptional circumstances. One does not marry a ñwingi! This would be an insult to one's wife. Nsabula would leave Mboza if Mboza were to marry Magugu, Komatane's wife, because they have been accustomed to call each other ñwingi.

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